“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 14

Beholding the Herā-pañcamī Festival

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 With His companions Gaura watched the festival of Śrī Lakṣmī’s procession, and when He heard of the gopīs’ rasa in all its exultation, He was filled with delight and danced in love.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Glory, glory to Nityānanda, and glory to the blessed Advaita![2]

3 Glory, glory to Śrīvāsa and all the devotees of Gaura! Glory to my listeners, whose life’s treasure is Gaura![3]

4 While the Lord lay thus enraptured by love, King Pratāparudra came in.

5 On Sārvabhauma’s advice he had laid aside his royal dress, and he entered alone, dressed as a Vaiṣṇava.[4]

6 With joined palms he asked permission of all the devotees. Then, mustering his courage, he fell down and clasped the Lord’s feet.

7 The Lord lay on the ground with His eyes closed in love, and the king skilfully massaged His feet.

8 He offered praise with the verses of the *rāsa-līlā*, reading aloud the chapter that begins "*jayati te 'dhikam*."[5]

9 As the Lord listened, His joy knew no bounds. "Go on, go on!" He said again and again.

10 When the king recited the verse "*tava kathāmṛtam*," the Lord rose in the rapture of love and embraced him.

11 "You have given Me many priceless jewels. I have nothing to give you in return, so I give you My embrace."

12 Saying this, the Lord recited that verse again and again. Both of them trembled, and tears streamed from their eyes.

13 "The nectar of Your words is the very life of those who burn with suffering. The wise have praised it, and it takes away all sin. It is auspicious to hear, full of power and spread far and wide. Those who proclaim it on earth are the most munificent of givers." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.9)[6]

14 "Most munificent! Most munificent!" cried the Lord as He embraced him. He did not know who the man was.[7]

15 Having seen the king's earlier service, the Lord felt mercy for him, and He bestowed His grace without asking who he was.

16 Just see how mighty Caitanya's mercy is! Without asking anything about a person, it crowns his life with success.[8]

17 The Lord said, "Who are you, who have done Me such good? You have come so suddenly and made Me drink the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes!"

18 The king said, “I am a servant of Your servants. Make me a servant of Your servants — that is my one hope.”[9]

19 Then Mahāprabhu revealed His divine majesty to him and forbade him: “Tell no one.”

20 He never showed any awareness that this was the king. Within He knew everything, but outwardly He seemed unconcerned.[10]

21 Seeing Pratāparudra’s good fortune, all the devotees praised the king with joyful hearts.

22 The king bowed down before the Lord, saluted all the devotees with joined palms and went out.

23 The Lord took His midday bath with the devotees, and then Vāṇīnātha arrived, bringing prasāda.[11]

24 Through Sārvabhauma, Rāmānanda and Vāṇīnātha the king had sent prasāda in great abundance.

25 There was the prasāda of the Balagaṇḍi offering, excellent and without limit, and endless prasāda of the *ni-sakaḍi* kind, not cooked in water.[12]

26 There were curd cheese and fruit drinks, green coconuts, mangoes, ripe coconuts and jackfruits, many kinds of bananas, and the soft kernels of palm fruits.[13]

27 Oranges, grapefruits, pomelos, tangerines and citrons; almonds, dried dates, grapes and pressed dates.

28 *Manoharā*, *laḍḍus* and a hundred other sweets; *amṛta-guṭikā* and the like, and *kṣīrsā* without measure.

29 *Amṛta-maṇḍā*, *saravatī* lemons, pumpkin shreds, *sarāmṛta*, *sarabhājā* and *sarapurī*.[14]

30 *Hari-vallabha*, *seṅoti*, *karpūra*, *mālatī*, *ḍāli-marica laḍḍus*, *navāta* and *amṛti*.[15]

31 *Padmacini*, *candrakānti*, *khājā*, *khaṇḍasāra*, *viyari*, *kadmā* and all kinds of sesame *khājā*.[16]

32 There were sweets of sugar shaped like orange, grapefruit and mango trees, complete with flowers, fruits and leaves.

33 Yogurt, milk, fresh butter, buttermilk, *rasālā* and *śikhariṇī*; salted mung sprouts and sliced ginger.

34 There were many kinds of pickles, of lemons, jujubes and other fruits. I cannot write down how many kinds of prasāda there were.

35 Half the garden was filled with prasāda, and Mahāprabhu was delighted to see it.

36 In this way Jagannātha took His meal, and the joy of seeing it soothed Mahāprabhu's eyes.

37 Five or seven loads of cups made of *ketakī* leaves were brought, so many that each person was given ten.

38 Gaurarāya knew how hard the kīrtana singers had laboured, and He longed to feed them all.

39 He seated the devotees row by row and began to serve them Himself.

40 But no one would eat unless the Lord ate, and so Svarūpa Gosāñi made a request:

41 “Lord, please sit down Yourself and take Your meal. Unless You eat, no one can eat.”

42 Then Mahāprabhu sat down with His companions and fed them all until they could eat no more.

43 When He had eaten and rinsed His mouth, the Lord sat down. So much prasāda was left over that a thousand people ate of it.

44 At the Lord’s order Govinda brought the poor and destitute, the suffering and the beggars, and fed them.

45 Gaurahari watched the beggars joyfully eating, and He instructed them to say “Hari bol!”[17]

46 As they said “Hari bol!” the beggars floated away in love. Such are the wonderful pastimes of Gaurarāya!

47 Meanwhile, when it was time for Jagannātha’s chariot to set out, all the *gauḍas* pulled at it, but it would not go forward.

48 Unable to pull it, the *gauḍas* let the chariot go. In alarm the king hurried there with his officers and friends.

49 He set mighty wrestlers to move the chariot and put his own hand to it too, but they could not pull it.

50 Growing anxious, the king brought maddened elephants and had them harnessed to the chariot to move it.

51 The maddened elephants pulled with all their strength, but the chariot would not move a single step. It stood fixed.

52 Hearing of this, Mahāprabhu came with His companions. He stood and watched the maddened elephants pulling the chariot.

53 The elephants screamed under the blows of the goad, yet the chariot would not move, and the people cried out in dismay.

54 Then Mahāprabhu had all the elephants taken away and gave the chariot ropes to His own companions to pull.

55 He Himself pushed the chariot from behind with His head, and with a rumbling roar the chariot rushed forward.

56 The devotees simply ran along holding the ropes in their hands. The chariot moved by itself, and they had no need to pull.

57 In their joy the people shouted "*Jaya! Jaya!*" Nothing could be heard but "*Jaya Jagannātha!*"

58 In an instant the chariot reached the gate of Guṇḍicā. Seeing Caitanya's might, the people were struck with wonder.

59 "Glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya!" With such a tumult the people sang His praises.

60 Seeing the Lord's glory, Pratāparudra, his officers and his friends thrilled with love in every limb.

61 Then the servants performed the *Pāṇḍu-vijaya*, and Jagannātha went and sat upon His throne.

62 Subhadrā and Balarāma came to their thrones too, and Jagannātha's bathing and offerings began.

63 In the courtyard Mahāprabhu and the devotees joyfully began to dance and sing kīrtana.

64 In His joy Mahāprabhu's love surged up, and all who saw Him floated in the ocean of love.

65 After the dance He watched the evening *ārati*. Then the Lord came to Āiṭoṭā and rested.

66 Advaita and the other devotees invited the Lord, and the nine chief among them received the nine days.[18]

67 The other devotees divided up all the days of the Cāturmāsya, one day each.

68 The chief devotees shared out the days of the four months among themselves, and the other devotees found no opportunity.

69 So two or three of them would join together to invite Him for a single day. Such was Mahāprabhu's pastime of invitations.

70 In the morning He bathed and saw Jagannātha, and then He danced in saṅkīrtana with the devotees.

71 Sometimes He made Advaita dance, sometimes Nityānanda; sometimes Haridāsa, sometimes Acyutānanda.

72 Sometimes He made Vakreśvara dance, and sometimes other devotees. Three times a day He held kīrtana in the courtyard of Guṇḍicā.

73 The Lord felt that Kṛṣṇa had come back to Vṛndāvana, and His feeling of separation from Kṛṣṇa came to an end.[19]

74 His mind was filled with Kṛṣṇa's pastimes with Rādhā, and the Lord Himself became immersed in this rasa.

75 In the various gardens He enacted the pastimes of Vṛndāvana with the devotees, and in the Indradyumna lake He sported in the water.

76 The Lord Himself splashed all the devotees with water, and they all surrounded Him and splashed Him from every side.

77 Sometimes they formed one circle and sometimes many, and all of them clapped their palms on the water, making a sound like frogs croaking.

78 Pairing off two by two, they fought water battles; some lost and some won, and the Lord looked on.

79 Advaita and Nityānanda threw water at each other. The Ācārya lost, and then began to hurl abuse.

80 Vidyānidhi played in the water with Svarūpa, and the two, Gupta and Datta, played together.

81 Gadādhara played in the water with Śrīvāsa, and Vakreśvara with Rāghava Paṇḍita.

82 Rāmānanda Rāya played with Sārvabhauma. Both of them lost all their gravity and became like children.

83 Seeing those two frolicking, Mahāprabhu smiled and said to Gopīnātha Ācārya:

84 “Both are learned, grave and respected men, yet they are frolicking like children. Make them stop.”

85 Gopīnātha said, “When a single drop of the great ocean of Your mercy overflows,

86 it drowns even the mountains Meru and Mandara wherever they stand. What then of these two, who are mere hillocks?[20]

87 His whole life was spent eating the oilcake of dry logic, and now You give him the nectar of divine pastimes to drink. Such is Your mercy!”[21]

88 Smiling, Mahāprabhu then brought Advaita and made Him His couch, like Śeṣa, upon the water.

89 He lay down upon Him, and so the Lord revealed the pastime of the One who lies on Śeṣa.

90 Advaita revealed His own power: carrying Mahāprabhu, He floated about on the water.

91 After sporting in the water like this for some time, the Lord returned to Āiṭoṭā with the devotees.

92 Purī, Bhāratī and all the other chief devotees took their meal at the Ācārya’s invitation.

93 Mahāprabhu’s companions ate all the rest of the prasāda that Vāṇīnātha had brought.

94 In the afternoon He came, took darśana and danced, and at night He returned to the garden to rest.

95 The next day He came again to see the Lord, and for some time He danced and sang in the courtyard.

96 Then the Lord came to the garden with the devotees and enjoyed the pastimes of Vṛndāvana with them.[22]

97 At the sight of the Lord the trees and creepers burst into bloom, the bees and cuckoos sang, and a cool breeze blew.

98 The Lord danced beneath every tree, while Vāsudeva Datta alone sang.

99 Beneath each tree he sang a new song, and Gaurarāya danced alone in supreme ecstasy.

100 Then the Lord told Vakreśvara to dance. Vakreśvara danced, and the Lord began to sing.

101 Svarūpa and the other singers sang with the Lord. In the flood of love they no longer knew where they were.

102 After enjoying the pastimes of the forest like this for some time, they went to the Narendra lake to play in the water.

103 After sporting in the water, the Lord came back to the garden and enjoyed the pastime of eating with the devotees.

104 For nine days Jagannātha stayed at Guṇḍicā, and all that time Mahāprabhu enjoyed such pastimes with the devotees.

105 There is a large flower garden called Jagannātha-vallabha, and the Lord rested there for those nine days.[23]

106 Knowing that the day of the Herā-pañcamī was at hand, the king spoke to Kāśī Miśra with great care.[24]

107 “Tomorrow is the Herā-pañcamī, the procession of Lakṣmī. Hold the festival as it has never been held before.

108 Prepare the great festival with such splendour that Mahāprabhu will be struck with wonder when He sees it.

109 From the Deity’s storehouse and from mine take coloured cloths, small bells, umbrellas and *cāmaras*.

110 Decorate everything with flags, banners and bells, and adorn the palanquin procession with music and dancing of every kind.

111 Make all the offerings double, so that the festival is more wonderful than the Ratha-yātrā.

112 And arrange it so that the Lord and His devotees can come at their ease and see it all.”[25]

113 In the morning Mahāprabhu went with His companions to Sundarācala and took darśana of Jagannātha.

114 Then He came back to Nīlācala with the devotees, eager to see the festivities of the Herā-pañcamī.

115 Kāśī Miśra received the Lord with great honour and seated Him with His companions in a good place.[26]

116 The Lord wished to hear about a special rasa, and with a slight smile He asked Svarūpa:

117–118 "Jagannātha enjoys His pastimes in Dvārakā, and there He naturally shows His supreme magnanimity. Still, once a year He feels a boundless longing to see Vṛndāvana.[27]

119 These gardens are like Vṛndāvana, and His heart longs to see them.

120 Outwardly He makes the Ratha-yātrā His pretext: the Lord leaves Nīlācala and goes to Sundarācala.

121 There He plays night and day in the many flower gardens. Why, then, does He not take Lakṣmī-devī with Him?"

122 Svarūpa said, "Hear the reason for this, Lord. Lakṣmī has no right to enter the pastimes of Vṛndāvana.[28]

123 In the pastimes of Vṛndāvana Kṛṣṇa's companions are the gopīs. No one but the gopīs can steal Kṛṣṇa's heart."

124 The Lord said, "Kṛṣṇa goes on the pretext of the festival, and with Him go two: Subhadrā and Baladeva.

125 All the pastimes He enjoys with the gopīs in the gardens remain hidden: no one knows Kṛṣṇa's secret heart.

126 So there is no fault at all in what Kṛṣṇa openly does. Why, then, is Lakṣmī-devī so angry?"[29]

127 Svarūpa said, "Such is the very nature of one who loves: at the slightest trace of indifference from her beloved, anger arises in her."[30]

128 Just then Lakṣmī-devī set out, mounted on a golden palanquin inlaid with jewels of every kind.[31]

129 Umbrellas, *cāmaras*, standards and flags came in multitudes, and the temple dancers (*deva-dāsīs*) danced before a band of many instruments.

130 Hundreds of maidservants went with her, carrying betel boxes, water jugs, fans and *cāmaras*, and adorned with necklaces, divine ornaments and fine garments.

131 With great splendour and a large retinue, Lakṣmī-devī came in anger to the Lion Gate.

132 Lakṣmī-devī's maidservants seized all of Jagannātha's chief servants and bound them.

133 They dragged them bound before Lakṣmī and threw them down at her feet, punishing them like thieves, as if to make them give back all kinds of riches.

134 They beat them until they were nearly senseless and heaped all kinds of abuse and mockery on them.

135 Seeing the boldness of Lakṣmī's maidservants, Mahāprabhu's associates laughed, covering their mouths with their hands.

136 Svarūpa Dāmodara said, "Where in the three worlds does one see *māna*, loving pique, of this kind? I have never heard of such a thing.

137 A woman in *māna* dejectedly lays aside her ornaments; she sits on the ground, her face clouded, and draws lines on it with her nails.

138 Long ago I heard of such *māna* in Satyabhāmā, and in Vraja the gopīs' *māna* is the same — a treasure-house of rasa.[32]

139 This goddess, however, displays all her wealth and marches against her beloved with an army in battle array!"

140 The Lord said, "Tell Me about the kinds of *māna* in Vraja." Svarūpa replied, "The river of the gopīs' *māna* flows in a hundred streams.

141 Heroines differ greatly in nature and in the workings of their love, and from these differences *māna* springs up in many forms.[33]

142 The gopīs' *māna* cannot be described in full; I shall give a glimpse of it through one or two of its varieties.

143 In *māna* some are *dhīrā*, composed; some are *adhīrā*, impetuous; and some, making the third division, are *dhīrādhīrā*, both composed and impetuous.

144 Seeing her lover from afar, the composed heroine rises to greet him, and when he comes near she offers him a seat.

145 Anger lies in her heart, but her lips speak sweet words; when her beloved embraces her, she embraces him in return.

146 Her behaviour is straightforward, yet she nurses her *māna*; or else she rebuffs her beloved with ironic words.

147 The impetuous heroine scolds her lover with harsh words; she strikes him with the lotus from her ear or binds him with her garland.

148 The heroine who is both composed and impetuous mocks him with sly, double-edged words: at times she praises him, at times she reproaches him,

and at times she is indifferent.

149 There are three kinds of heroine: *mugdhā* (artless), *madhyā* (intermediate) and *pragalbhā* (bold). The artless heroine does not know the artful ways of *māna*.

150 She only covers her face and weeps, and when she hears her lover's tender words, she is pacified.

151 It is the intermediate and the bold heroines who are divided into *dhīrā* and the rest; and all of them, by nature, are again of three kinds.

152 Some are *prakharā*, sharp; some are *mṛdu*, gentle; and some are *samā*, balanced. Each, by her own nature, expands the bounds of Kṛṣṇa's love.

153 Sharpness, gentleness and a balanced nature are all faultless, and by each of these natures they delight Kṛṣṇa."

154 Hearing this, the Lord felt boundless bliss. "Go on, go on, Dāmodara!" He said again and again.

155 Dāmodara said, "Kṛṣṇa is the crown of all who relish rasa. He tastes rasa, and His very body is made of rasa.

156 Kṛṣṇa's form is made of love, and He is subject to the love of His devotees. In pure love and in the qualities of rasa the gopīs are supremely expert.

157 In the gopīs' love there is no fault of *rasābhāsa*, a mere semblance of rasa; therefore it gives Kṛṣṇa supreme satisfaction."[34]

158 “Thus Kṛṣṇa, whose desires are ever true, spent in the *rāsa* dance all those autumn nights resplendent with moonlight — nights that poetry sings of as the abode of rasa. The maidens devoted to Him were all around Him, yet He kept His amorous feelings within Himself.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.25)[35]

159 “One group of gopīs is *vāmā*, contrary, and another is *dakṣiṇā*, compliant. Through their various moods they let Kṛṣṇa taste rasa.[36]

160 Among the gopīs the foremost is Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī, a mine of the jewels of love in the pure and radiant rasa (*ujjvala-rasa*).

161 In age She is *madhyā*, in the bloom of youth; by nature She is *samā*, balanced; yet in the depth of Her love She is always *vāmā*, contrary.[37]

162 From Her contrary nature *māna* constantly arises, and with it surges the ocean of Kṛṣṇa’s bliss.”

163 “Like the movement of a snake, the course of love is winding by nature. Therefore pique (*māna*) arises between the young lovers, with cause and without cause.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Śṛṅgāra-bheda-kathana, 102)[38]

164 When the Lord heard this, the ocean of His bliss swelled. “Go on, go on,” He said, and Dāmodara continued:

165 “Rādhikā’s love is *adhirūḍha mahābhāva*, the highest summit of *mahābhāva*. It is utterly pure and spotless, like gold refined in fire.[39]

166 Whenever She suddenly catches sight of Kṛṣṇa, She becomes adorned with the ornaments of many *bhāvas*, ecstatic feelings.

167 Hers are the eight *sāttvika* transformations, the *vyabhicārī-bhāvas* beginning with joy, Her natural love and the twenty ornaments of *bhāva*:

168 *kila-kiñcita*, *kuṭṭamita*, *vilāsa*, *lalita*, *bibboka*, *moṭṭāyita*, *maugdhya*, *cakita* and others.[40]

169 When Kṛṣṇa sees Śrī Rādhā's form adorned with so many ornaments of *bhāva*, the waves of the ocean of His happiness surge high.

170 Now hear a description of *kila-kiñcita* and the other *bhāvas*, the ornaments of feeling by which Rādhā steals Kṛṣṇa's mind.

171 When Kṛṣṇa sees Rādhā and wants to touch Her, when He bars Her way on the path to the toll crossing (*dāna-ghāṭi*),[41]

172 when He comes and forbids Her to pick flowers, or when He tries to touch Her in front of Her friends —

173 in all these situations *kila-kiñcita* arises. Its root cause is the *sañcārī-bhāva* of joy (*harṣa*), which comes first.

174 "The mingling of pride, longing, weeping, smiling, envy, fear and anger, born of joy, is called *kila-kiñcita*." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Vibhāva-kathana, 71)

175 The other seven *bhāvas* come and naturally combine with joy, and from the union of these eight *bhāvas* arises *mahābhāva*.

176 The seven are pride, longing, fear, tearless weeping, anger, envy and a faint smile.

177 These eight *bhāvas*, each of a different flavour, meet in one, and in tasting that blend Kṛṣṇa's mind is fully satisfied.

178 It is like *rasālā*, a drink made sweet by blending yogurt, sugar, ghee, honey, black pepper, camphor and cardamom.[42]

179 Seeing Rādhā's face and eyes filled with these *bhāvas*, Kṛṣṇa feels ten million times more happiness than in union with Her.

180 "When Mādhava stopped Rādhā on the path, Her glance shone with a smile held within. Tears beaded Her lashes, the corners of Her eyes were faintly reddened, and, brimming with playful delight, Her eyes narrowed as their pupils rose sweetly, slyly upward. May that glance of Rādhā's, a bouquet of *kila-kiñcita*, bring you good fortune!" (Dāna-keli-kaumudī, 1)[43]

181 "Seeing Rādhā's face adorned with *kila-kiñcita* — Her restless eyes clouded with tears and reddened at the corners, Her face alight with rasa, Her lips trembling with playful delight, Her brows arched and a smile dawning — Kṛṣṇa attained a bliss ten million times greater than that of union with Her, a bliss beyond the reach of words." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 9.18)

182 Hearing this, the Lord rejoiced at heart, and, absorbed in happiness, He embraced Svarūpa.

183 "Now tell Me the characteristics of *vilāsa* and the other ornaments of *bhāva* by which Rādhā steals Govinda's mind."

184 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi began to speak, and the Lord's devotees were overjoyed to hear him.

185 "Rādhā may be sitting, or going into the forest of Vṛndāvana, when suddenly She catches sight of Kṛṣṇa.

186 When She sees Him, various *bhāvas* appear in Her in an extraordinary way, and that distinctiveness is called the ornament of *vilāsa*.

187 “When a heroine meets her beloved, a momentary distinctiveness appears in her gait, in the way she stands and sits, and in the movements of her face, eyes and other features. This is called *vilāsa*.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Vibhāva-kathana, 67)

188 Shyness, joy, longing, flurry, contrariness and fear — all these *bhāvas* combine and make Rādhā restless.

189 “When She saw Kṛṣṇa before Her, Her gait halted and wavered; Her lovely face turned aside, half covered by Her dark veil; and Her wide eyes glanced sidelong, their pupils darting. Thus, adorned with Her own ornament called *vilāsa*, She became Her beloved’s delight.” (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 9.11)

190 When Rādhā stands before Kṛṣṇa, Her body bends in three places and She makes Her brows dance.

191 When Her face and eyes pour forth many *bhāvas*, this mood of the beloved heroine is called the ornament of *lalita*.

192 “Where the poise of the limbs is graceful and delicate, charming with the play of the brows, that is called *lalita*.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Vibhāva-kathana, 75)

193 When Kṛṣṇa sees Rādhā adorned with *lalita*, They both long to meet each other.

194 “Bashfully turning Her neck aside and bending Her feet and waist, She looked most charming; the moving creepers of Her brows broke the mighty

bow of Kāmadeva; Her graceful, cherished body glowed with the joy of love for Her beloved. Thus, for Her beloved's delight, She was adorned with the ornament of *lalita*, which had arisen in Her." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 9.14)

195 When Kṛṣṇa eagerly comes and pulls at Her bodice (*kañcuka*), Rādhā is delighted within, yet She wards Him off.

196 Outwardly She shows contrariness and anger, but inwardly She is happy at heart. Among the ornaments this *bhāva* is called *kuṭṭamita*.

197 "When her breasts, lips and so on are touched, the heroine, though joyful at heart, shows anger outwardly in her agitation, as if she were pained. The wise call this *kuṭṭamita*." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Anubhāva-prakaraṇa, 49)

198 She checks Kṛṣṇa's hand, and yet His desire is fulfilled; within, Rādhā feels bliss, while outwardly She shows contrariness and anger.

199 As if in pain, She weeps without tears, and with a faint smile She rebukes Kṛṣṇa.

200 "Rādhā, whose thighs are like an elephant's trunk, checks Mādhava's hand without obstructing His desire; She rebukes Him with a sweet smile hidden in Her words; and on Her face there is a charming, tearless weeping."[44]

201 In the same way there are all the other ornaments of *bhāva*; adorned with them, Rādhā steals Kṛṣṇa's mind.

202 Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are endless; they cannot be described in full, even if the thousand-mouthed Ananta Himself describes them."

203 Śrīvāsa said with a smile, “Listen, Dāmodara! See the abundant wealth of my Lakṣmī!

204 And see the wealth of Vṛndāvana: flowers and young shoots, mountain minerals, peacock feathers and *guñjā* berries!

205 Jagannātha went to see Vṛndāvana, and when Lakṣmī-devī heard of it, she grew uneasy at heart.

206 ‘Why did He leave so much wealth and go to Vṛndāvana?’ Lakṣmī thought, and to make fun of Him she arrayed herself in all her splendour.

207 ‘Look at your master! He has left all this wealth and gone to a flower garden, greedy for leaves, fruits and flowers.

208 Would the crown jewel of connoisseurs ever do such a thing? Bring your master before Lakṣmī!’

209 Saying this, all of Mahā-Lakṣmī’s maidservants bound the Lord’s own servants with waistcloths and brought them before her.

210 At Lakṣmī’s feet they made them bow down; they exacted a fine from them and made them plead humbly.

211 They beat the chariot with sticks and treated Jagannātha’s servants almost like thieves.

212 All the servants said with folded hands, ‘Tomorrow we shall bring Jagannātha before you.’

213 Then Lakṣmī, pacified, went back to her own home. The wealth of my Lakṣmī is beyond words!

214 Your gopīs boil milk and churn yogurt, while my mistress sits on a jewelled throne."[45]

215 Śrīvāsa, whose nature is like Nārada's, joked in this way, and all of Mahāprabhu's own servants laughed to hear him.[46]

216 The Lord said, "Śrīvāsa, you have Nārada's nature: in the mood of majesty (*aiśvarya*), the Lord's power holds sway over you.

217 But this Svarūpa Dāmodara is a pure resident of Vraja. Floating in pure love, he does not know majesty."

218 Svarūpa said, "Śrīvāsa, listen carefully! Does the wealth of Vṛndāvana not come to your mind?

219 In Vṛndāvana there is a natural ocean of wealth, and the wealth of Dvārakā and Vaikuṇṭha is but a drop of it.

220 Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Puruṣottama, Bhagavān Himself, and where He is rich, there is His abode, Vṛndāvana.[47]

221 There the ground is made of *cintāmaṇi* gems and the houses of jewels; *cintāmaṇi* gems are the ornaments on the maidservants' feet.

222 There the natural forest is made of wish-fulfilling trees and creepers, yet no one asks them for any wealth but flowers and fruits.

223 Countless wish-fulfilling cows wander there from forest to forest; they give only milk, and no one asks them for any other wealth.

224 There the ordinary talk of the people is a divine song, and their ordinary walking seems like dancing.

225 Everywhere the water is like nectar, and the light of spiritual bliss takes form there, to be relished.[48]

226 There the gopīs, a whole society of Lakṣmīs, surpass Lakṣmī in their qualities, and Kṛṣṇa's flute serves as a dear friend.[49]

227 "There the beloveds are goddesses of fortune and the lover is the Supreme Person; the trees are wish-fulfilling trees; the ground is made of *cintāmaṇi* gems and the water is nectar; speech is song and walking is dance; the flute is a dear friend; and the supreme light is spiritual bliss, there to be relished." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.56)[50]

228 "In Vṛndāvana *cintāmaṇi* is the ornament of the maidens' feet; the trees of the gods supply the flowers for their adornment; and the wealth of Vraja is herds of wish-fulfilling cows. Ah, this splendour is an ocean of happiness!" (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.173)[51]

229 Hearing this, Śrīvāsa danced in the rapture of love, clapping his hands under his arms and laughing loudly.

230 In rapture the Lord heard of Rādhā's pure rasa, and, overwhelmed by that rasa, He began to dance.

231 Absorbed in rasa, the Lord danced and Svarūpa sang. "Sing on, sing on!" the Lord kept saying, all ears.

232 As He heard the songs of Vraja's rasa, His love welled up, and the Lord flooded the town of Puruṣottama with it.

233 In due time Lakṣmī-devī went back to her own home. The Lord went on dancing, and the second watch of the day (*prahara*) had come.

234 The four groups grew very tired from singing, but Mahāprabhu's rapture of love doubled.

235 In the rapture of Rādhā's love the Lord assumed Her very form. Seeing this from afar, Nityānanda offered prayers.

236 Seeing the Lord's rapture, Nityānanda would not come near but kept somewhat at a distance.[52]

237 Who but Nityānanda could hold the Lord? His rapture did not subside, and the kīrtana did not stop.

238 By a skilful hint Svarūpa made the Lord aware of everyone's fatigue, and seeing how tired the devotees were, the Lord returned to outer awareness.

239 Taking all the devotees with Him, the Lord went to the flower garden; there He rested and then took His midday bath.

240 Many offerings of Jagannātha's prasāda arrived, and with them Lakṣmī's prasāda of every kind.[53]

241 With everyone around Him, the Lord ate joyfully. After His evening bath He went for darśana of Jagannātha.

242 Seeing Jagannātha, He danced and sang kīrtana; then He played in the water of Narendra Lake with the devotees.

243 Coming to the garden, He had a meal in the grove. In this way the Lord enjoyed His pastimes for eight days.

244 The next day was Jagannātha's return (*bhitara-vijaya*): mounting His chariot, He went back to His own abode.

245 As before, the Lord, together with the devotees, danced and sang kīrtana in supreme bliss.

246 Once again Jagannātha's *pāṇḍu-vijaya* took place, and one of the silk ropes broke.[54]

247 The cotton pads used for the *pāṇḍu-vijaya* tore and burst, and under Jagannātha's weight the cotton flew up and scattered.

248 Rāmānanda and Satyarāja Khān of Kulīna-grāma were there, and the Lord respectfully gave them an order:

249 "Be the patrons (*yajamāna*) of these silk ropes: every year have the ropes made and bring them here."[55]

250 So saying, He gave them the torn silk rope. "Look at this," He said, "and make the ropes very strong.

251 In this silk rope resides Śeṣa, who serves Bhagavān by assuming ten forms."

252 Fortunate indeed were Satyarāja and Rāmānanda: receiving the order to serve, they felt supreme bliss.

253 Every year after that, they came with the devotees to the Guṇḍicā festival with great joy, bringing silk ropes.

254 Then Jagannātha went and sat upon His throne, and Mahāprabhu came home with the devotees.

255 In this way the Lord showed the devotees the Herā-pañcamī festival and, together with them, enacted the pastimes of Vṛndāvana.[56]

256 The pastimes of Caitanya Gosāñi are endless and boundless; even the thousand-mouthed Śeṣa cannot reach their end.

257 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[57]

Notes

1. Heading in the edition: “Gaurasundara dances as He watches the Herā-pañcamī.” *Anubhāṣya*: *gopī-rasollāsa* is the highest pitch of the gopīs’ *parakīya-rasa*. ↩
2. The second line is the same as Ādi 12.2; translation as there. ↩
3. The first line is the same as Ādi 9.3 and Madhya 12.3; translation as there. ↩
4. Heading in the edition: “Dressed as a humble Vaiṣṇava, with the permission of all the Vaiṣṇavas, [the king] massages the feet of the Lord, who lies with His eyes closed.” ↩
5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the chapter “*Jayati te ’dhikam*” is the *Gopī-gītā*, one of the five chapters of the *rāsa* dance (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31). Heading in the edition: “The king recites the *Gopī-gītā*.” ↩
6. *Anubhāṣya*: the gopīs sing this verse when Kṛṣṇa has vanished from the *rāsa* dance; *tapta-jīvanam* — the life of those who burn in separation from Him; *kalmaṣāpaham* — taking away the anguish of the fever of separation; *kavi* — those who know the rasa of Kṛṣṇa. Heading in the edition: “One who gives away the nectar of the Lord’s narrations is the most munificent of givers.” ↩
7. Heading in the edition: “Unaware [of who was before Him, the Lord] embraces the king.” *Anubhāṣya*: the first *iṅho* is Mahāprabhu, the second the king Pratāparudra. ↩
8. Heading in the edition: “Caitanya’s mercy does not weigh a person’s fitness and needs no cause.” ↩
9. Heading in the edition: “The king introduces himself as ‘a servant of the servants of Kṛṣṇa’.” ↩
10. Heading in the edition: “The all-knowing Lord, in His outer consciousness, does not reveal that in the trance of love He had seen the king.” ↩
11. Heading in the edition: “After the midday bath Vāṇīnātha brings abundant prasāda for all.” ↩

12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *ni-sakaḍi* is yogurt, thickened milk (*kṣīra*), fruits, roots and everything else that is not *sakaḍi*, food cooked in water. *Anubhāṣya*: the list in verses 25–34 shows how well the author knows the whole variety of offerings to Kṛṣṇa. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: *bīja-tāla* is the soft kernel of the palm fruit (*tāla-śāṁs*). ↩
14. *Anubhāṣya*: *saravatī* is a choice kind of lemon; another reading of *amṛta-maṇḍā* is *amṛta-bhāṇḍa*, papaya. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: *ḍāli-marica-lāḍu* are balls made of mung; *navāta* is a sweet boiled in sugar syrup; *amṛti* is a sweet fried in ghee, like *jilipi*. ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: *candrakānti* are thin flatbreads of *urad* dal or puffed moon-shaped *baḍis*; *viyari* is a flatbread of puffed rice; *kadmā* is a very hard sweet of rice flour in sugar syrup; *tilā-khājā* is *khājā* with sesame fried in ghee. ↩
17. Heading in the edition: “Gaurahari watches the beggars eat and teaches them to sing the name of Hari.” ↩
18. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the nine days of the festival at Guṇḍicā’s house are called the *nava-rātra-yātrā*; all those days the Lord stayed with the devotees at Āiṭoṭā, and the nine chief devotees headed by Advaita invited Him, each on his own day. ↩
19. Heading in the edition: “The joy of the Lord, who is in the mood of a gopī, a maidservant of Śrī Rādhā, that Kṛṣṇa has come to Vraja and met Śrī Rādhā.” ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: *gaṇḍa-śaila* — small hills; though “these two” are named, the words are aimed above all at Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya. ↩
21. *Anubhāṣya*: before he received Mahāprabhu’s mercy, Sārvabhauma knew only the impersonal Brahman and followed the path of logic, so Gopīnātha likened him to the oil-presser’s ox that eats the oilcake. ↩
22. *Anubhāṣya*: although the Lord began the pastimes of Vṛndāvana here, He has no pastimes as the enjoyer (*bhoktā*) such as Kṛṣṇa has in *parakīya-rasa*: He thinks of Himself as a maidservant of Śrī Rādhā and is immersed in an ocean of bliss when Rādhā meets Kṛṣṇa, and it was in this mood that He enjoyed the *vṛndāvana-vihāra* with the devotees (cf. verses 73–75). The teaching of *gaura-nāgarī* therefore has no place here at all. ↩
23. Heading in the edition: “The Lord rests at Jagannātha-vallabha.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the garden Jagannātha-vallabha lies about halfway between Guṇḍicā-bāḍī and the temple; there the pastime of “stealing the *danā*” takes place: Śrī Madana-mohana comes there and carries off the fragrant plant called *danā*. ↩

24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Herā-pañcamī is the fifth day after the Ratha-yātrā: Lakṣmī-devī, searching for Jagannātha, goes to Guṇḍicā, and having seen (*heriyā*) Him she returns; this is why the people of Utkala call the day “Herā-pañcamī”. ↩
25. Heading in the edition: “He arranges for the Lord to watch at His ease.” ↩
26. Heading in the edition: “Kāśī Miśra seats the Lord in the best place.” ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: out of compassion for the *jīvas*, Śrī Jagannāthadeva sits in the temple at Nīlācala and shows Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes of Dvārakā; once a year there awakens in Him an intense longing to see Sundarācala, which is like Vṛndāvana. ↩
28. *Anubhāṣya*: Lakṣmī cannot take part in the pastimes of Vṛndāvana, and so Jagannātha does not take her with Him when He goes to Sundarācala. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: see *Bṛhad-bhāgavatāmṛta*, part 1, chapter 7. ↩
30. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: as He sets out, Jagannātha tells Lakṣmī, “I shall be back tomorrow,” but two or three days pass, and Lakṣmī in her love, seeing even a shadow of indifference in her Beloved, by her very nature flares up in anger. Heading in the edition: “Svarūpa gives the reason: when the beloved is indifferent, the loving woman becomes angry and offended.” ↩
31. Heading in the edition: “Lakṣmī comes in great pomp with many maidservants.” ↩
32. Heading in the edition: “Such too is the *māna* of the gopīs of Vraja and of Satyabhāmā.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: such is the *māna* of the gopīs in Vraja, and Satyabhāmā shows the same, but Lakṣmī’s *māna* is the very opposite. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: on the kinds of heroines, of group leaders and of friends, see the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*. ↩
34. *Anubhāṣya*: *rasābhāsa* is a “semblance of rasa”, a rasa in which its defining marks are distorted (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Uttara-vibhāga, 9th wave); it is of three kinds — *uparasa*, *anurasa* and *aparasa*. ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: *avaruddha-saurata* — He is *ātmārāma*, the transcendental Kāmadeva. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the gopīs, Vṛndāvana, those nights and the *rāsa* dance itself are wholly spiritual; Kṛṣṇa never so much as glances at material love. ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*): the *vāmā* heroine is ever ready for *māna*, is angered when it slackens and does not yield to the hero; the *dakṣiṇā* cannot bear prolonged *māna* and softens at his tender words. ↩
37. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in age She is *madhyā*, by nature *samā*, and always *vāmā*; from this contrariness *māna* is born. ↩

38. The same verse as Madhya 8.110; translation as there. ↩
39. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*): when the *sāttvika-anubhāvas* of *rūḍha-bhāva* reach an indescribable distinction, this is called *adhirūḍha-mahābhāva*. ↩
40. *Bibboka* — so spelt in the edition and the commentaries (বিব্বোক). *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*): *bibboka* is disregard, out of pride and *māna*, even for what one desires; *moṭṭāyita*, the longing that wakes in the heart at the memory of the beloved or at talk of him; *maugdhya*, asking the beloved about what one knows as if one did not know; *cakita*, great fear before the beloved where there is nothing to fear. ↩
41. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa says, “Until You pay the toll, I forbid You to go along this road,” and so begins the toll-collecting pastime (*dāna-keli*). ↩
42. Heading in the edition: “A comparison with a sweet drink.” ↩
43. Heading in the edition: “the words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī”. *Anubhāṣya*: all seven *bhāvas* are in this glance — the smile, weeping, anger (the reddened corners), pride and longing (brimming with playful delight) and fear (the narrowing). ↩
44. Heading in the edition: “a verse of the Gosvāmipāda”. ↩
45. Heading in the edition: “Speaking of Lakṣmī’s majesty, Śrīvāsa teases Svarūpa.” ↩
46. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord’s “own servants” are Gadādhara and the others who form His potency (*śakti*); they are wholly devoted to the service of Śrī Rādhā-Govinda and absorbed in *rāgātmikā-bhakti*. ↩
47. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Vṛndāvana-dhāma is the place where Kṛṣṇa, setting majesty aside, counts Himself rich in the sweetness of leaves, flowers and the like. ↩
48. *Anubhāṣya* (on 227): the supreme light there — the moon, the sun and the rest — is made of spiritual bliss and is meant to be relished. ↩
49. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: there dwell countless millions of Lakṣmīs full of sweetness, who have surpassed the Lakṣmī of majesty. ↩
50. *Anubhāṣya*: the goddesses of fortune are the gopīs; the Lover is the One without a second enjoyer; the trees yield the fruit of love for Kṛṣṇa; everything there is beyond matter and meant for Kṛṣṇa’s enjoyment alone. ↩
51. Heading in the edition: “the words of Bilvamaṅgala, quoted in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, first wave”. ↩
52. The edition prints *nikaṭe āise* without *nā* (“not”), an evident misprint: the edition’s headings (“Fearing to disturb the rasa, Nitāi praises the Lord from afar”; “As Nitāi does not come near…”) and the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*

confirm the reading “does not come near”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: seeing that the Lord, in the rapture of Rādhā’s love, had shown the form of Rādhikā, Nityānanda Prabhu kept at a distance, for it did not befit his position (*adhikāra-virodha*). ↩

53. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: some doubt whether Lakṣmī-devī’s prasāda may be taken — yet Mahāprabhu Himself took it with His devotees. Lakṣmī and all the potencies are the Lord’s maidservants: they offer what is given to them to their Lord and only then partake, so the prasāda of His servants and maidservants is to be honoured as the prasāda of Bhagavān Himself. ↩
54. Heading in the edition: “During the *pahāṇḍi* the silk rope partly gives way.” ↩
55. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: silk is woven in many villages near Kulīna-grāma, and so the Lord charged Rāmānanda Vasu and Satyarāja Khān, as *yajamānas*, with bringing the silk ropes. ↩
56. Heading in the edition: “He shows the devotees the Herā-pañcamī and reveals the pastimes of Vraja.” ↩
57. The same colophon as Madhya 7.155; translation as there. ↩